DIVORCED DADS NOW

THE DIVORCED DAD'S PLAYBOOK

Free Fillable Worksheets

All eleven worksheets from the book, ready to type into, save, and print.

How to use this workbook

Every worksheet from the book is here, with a short note at the top of each page on what it's for and when to fill it in. A few run two pages.

To type into it, open this file in Adobe Acrobat Reader, which is free. Click any line or box to type, press Tab to move to the next field, and save a copy with your own file name so you don't lose your work. Totals on the Lawyer Scorecard and Monthly Budget add themselves up. You can also print it blank and fill it in by hand.

Apple Preview and some browser viewers may not save every field reliably. If something you typed disappears, switch to Acrobat Reader.

Bring the finished pages to your first consult. You'll spend less of it answering questions you could have answered on paper.

Keep this file somewhere private, on a device and account only you use.

WHAT'S INSIDE

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Free companion to The Divorced Dad's Playbook. Print and copy these worksheets as often as you need for your own case. © 2026 Divorced Dads Now.

Parenting Log

HOW TO USE THIS

Before you start the daily log, write down what you've already been doing for the kids over the past year. Be accurate, and write today's date at the top so it's clear this is a look back, not notes made at the time.

WRITTEN ON (TODAY'S DATE) _____

CHILD OR CHILDREN _____

Category	How often	Examples, with dates if you have them	Proof (texts, emails, photos, sign-up sheets)
School drop-off and pickup			
Doctor and dentist visits			
Practices and games			
Bedtimes and mornings			
Homework			
School events and teacher meetings			
Meals			
Other			

Parenting Log

HOW TO USE THIS

One row per day, every day, whether the kids were with you or not. Two or three minutes, at about the same time each night. Facts only: times, places, what you did. If something goes wrong, put one line here and the full story on Worksheet 5. Keep going until the case is closed.

Date	Time with me (from, to)	What we did	School or medical	Exchange (time, place, on time?)	Notes

Lawyer Scorecard

HOW TO USE THIS

Fill this out in the parking lot, right after each consult. Write the facts at the top. Then score the seven lines from 1 (poor) to 5 (great) and add them up, for a top score of 35. If two lawyers come out close, go with the one you'd rather hear from at 9 at night when something goes wrong.

What you're scoring	Lawyer A	Lawyer B	Lawyer C
THE FACTS (NOT SCORED)			
Name and firm			
Consult date			
Hourly rate			
Retainer			
Billing increment			
Who would handle my case day to day			
THE SCORES (1 POOR TO 5 GREAT)			
Family law focus and experience			
Knows my county's judges			
Straight answers, including the hard ones			
Asked about my kids and my role as a dad			
Clear on cost and billing			
Responsive before I paid			
I'd trust them in a bad week			
Total (out of 35)			

NOTES *Their answers to question 12 (weakest part of my case) and question 25 (what would worry you)*

LAWYER A: Q12 · Q25

LAWYER B: Q12 · Q25

LAWYER C: Q12 · Q25

Monthly Budget

HOW TO USE THIS

Pull out your last three months of bank and card statements and use real averages, not guesses. Column one is what your household costs now. Column two is what your own household will cost after you separate. Bring it to your first lawyer meeting, since support numbers start here, and update it once a month.

Income (monthly)	Now	After
My take-home pay		
Other income		
Support I receive		
Total income		

LEFT OVER OR SHORT

NOW _____ AFTER _____

Total income minus total expenses. Below zero means short.

Expenses (monthly)	Now	After
Rent or mortgage		
Utilities: power, water, gas, internet		
Phones		
Groceries and household supplies		
Car payments		
Gas and car upkeep		
Insurance: health, car, home, life		
Kids: childcare		
Kids: school costs and lunches		
Kids: activities and sports		
Kids: clothes		
Uninsured medical and dental		
Debt payments: credit cards, loans		
Support I pay		
Lawyer and court costs		
Subscriptions and memberships		
Everything else		
Total expenses		

Financial Inventory

HOW TO USE THIS

List every account, asset, and debt you know about, in either name, including the ones you're not sure count. Check each balance online or on a statement and write the date you checked. Mark whether you think it's marital or separate, and why. Your lawyer makes the final call. Put a check in the last column once you have a copy of the statement.

Item	Institution	Whose name	Balance or value	Date checked	Marital, separate, or not sure	Statement copy?
Checking		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
Savings		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
Retirement: 401(k)		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
Retirement: IRA		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
Pension		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
Investments		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
House: value		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
Vehicles		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
Business interests		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
Other valuables		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐

Financial Inventory

HOW TO USE THIS

Same columns as page 1. List every debt in either name, then use the blank rows for anything that didn't fit: a timeshare, money owed to you, a storage unit, crypto, frequent-flyer miles. If you're not sure it counts, list it and let your lawyer decide.

Item	Institution	Whose name	Balance or value	Date checked	Marital, separate, or not sure	Statement copy?
House: mortgage owed		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
Vehicle loans		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
Credit cards		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
Other loans		*mine · hers · joint*			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
		mine · hers · joint			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
		mine · hers · joint			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
		mine · hers · joint			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
		mine · hers · joint			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
		mine · hers · joint			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐
		mine · hers · joint			*marital · separate · not sure*	☐

Incident Journal

HOW TO USE THIS

Only for something that actually happened: a missed exchange, a threat, a denied phone call, the kids dropped off sick with no heads-up. One page per incident, written the same day. Write it so a stranger could follow it: times, places, exact words in quotes. No opinions and no adjectives. Keep these separate from your parenting log and show them to your lawyer and nobody else.

INCIDENT # DATE AND TIME IT HAPPENED DATE AND TIME I WROTE THIS

WHERE WHO WAS THERE, INCLUDING THE KIDS

WHAT HAPPENED, STEP BY STEP

EXACT WORDS, IN QUOTES

WITNESSES

EVIDENCE SAVED (SCREENSHOTS, PHOTOS)

WHAT I DID IN RESPONSE

SENT TO MY LAWYER ON

Parenting Plan Builder

HOW TO USE THIS

Go section by section. In the first column, write what you're asking for, with days, times, places, and deadlines. In the second, what you could live with. In the third, one line on why it works for the kids. That last column is what you'll say in mediation. Give the finished draft to your lawyer before you show it to anyone else.

Section	What I want	What I'd accept	Why it works for the kids
1. Regular schedule, days and times			
2. Exchange location and times			
3. Grace period for late exchanges			
4. Holidays (Worksheet 7)			
5. Spring and winter break			
6. Summer weeks and selection deadline			
7. School decisions			
8. Medical decisions			
9. Tiebreaker for disagreements			
10. Phone and video calls with the kids			

Parenting Plan Builder

HOW TO USE THIS

Keep going, same as page 1: what you want, what you could live with, and one line on why it works for the kids. Then hand both pages to your lawyer before anyone else sees them.

Section	What I want	What I'd accept	Why it works for the kids
11. Travel notice, in state and out of state			
12. International travel and passports			
13. Moving notice and any distance limit			
14. Right of first refusal, hour threshold			
15. Activity cost split			
16. Uninsured medical split and deadline			
17. How we communicate: app and response time			
18. New partners			
19. Disputes: mediation first?			

Holiday Schedule

HOW TO USE THIS

Start with the days your family actually celebrates and cross out the ones you don't. For each, write the start and end time, then who has the kids in even years and odd years. A few days usually stay the same every year, like Mother's Day and Father's Day. Those are filled in as a starting point, so change them if your plan says otherwise. Add one row per child for birthdays. This grid becomes the holiday section of your parenting plan.

Holiday	Starts (day and time)	Ends (day and time)	Even years	Odd years
New Year's Eve and Day				
Easter or spring holiday				
Mother's Day			Mom	Mom
Memorial Day				
Father's Day			Dad	Dad
July 4				
Labor Day				
Halloween				
Thanksgiving				
Christmas Eve				
Christmas Day				
Child 1 birthday				
Child 2 birthday				
Child 3 birthday				
Dad's birthday				
Mom's birthday				
Religious or cultural holidays				

Mediation Prep

HOW TO USE THIS

Fill it in a few days before mediation and go over it with your lawyer. Keep the must-haves to three, or they stop meaning anything. Use real numbers from Worksheets 3 and 4. Write your walk-away point while you're calm, because by hour seven you won't be. Bring it with you. Don't sign anything while you're exhausted.

MY MUST-HAVES

The two or three things I won't trade.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

MY TRADES

What I'd give up to get a must-have.

I'd give up	To get

MY NUMBERS

Real numbers from Worksheets 3 and 4.

Item	Amount
My monthly take-home pay	
Her monthly take-home pay, best estimate	
Estimated child support	
House value minus mortgage	
Retirement accounts, total	
Debts, total	
Legal fees so far	
Estimated cost to go to trial	

MY WALK-AWAY POINT

- The worst deal I'd still take over going to trial.

_____

_____

_____

_____

QUESTIONS FOR MY LAWYER

_____

_____

_____

_____

Court Day Checklist

HOW TO USE THIS
Go through it the night before, then again that morning, and check each box. Read the testimony rules one last time in the hallway.

THE NIGHT BEFORE

- [ ] Court clothes laid out, what you'd wear to a job interview
- [ ] Courthouse address, parking, and courtroom number checked
- [ ] Leaving early enough to arrive 30 minutes ahead, with time for security screening
- [ ] Childcare and work covered for the whole day
- [ ] Only the documents my lawyer told me to bring, in one folder
- [ ] Nothing in my pockets that won't get through security

THE MORNING OF

- [ ] Ate breakfast
- [ ] Phone off or left in the car
- [ ] Listen, pause, answer only the question, then stop
- [ ] No reactions to anything she or her witnesses say
- [ ] Talk about my kids by name and what I do for them
- [ ] Nothing posted about today, before or after

QUESTIONS FOR MY LAWYER

ON THE STAND *Read this in the hallway*

- Listen to the whole question. Pause. Then answer.
- Answer only what was asked. Then stop talking.
- If you don't know or don't remember, say so. Don't guess.
- Tell the truth, even when it hurts you.

Decree Summary

HOW TO USE THIS

The week your decree is signed, boil it down to this one page, with the page number from the decree next to each line so you can find the exact wording fast. Keep a photo of it on your phone. Put every deadline in your calendar with a reminder a month ahead. When a question comes up, check here, then the decree, then your lawyer.

COURT _____ CASE NUMBER _____ DECREE DATE _____

Item	What it says	Decree page
Regular schedule		
Exchange times and places		
This year's holidays		
Summer selection deadline		
Travel notice rules		
Moving notice and limits		
Right of first refusal		
Child support amount and due date		
How support is paid, and the agency case number		
Health insurance: who covers the kids		
Uninsured medical split and deadline		
Activity cost split		
Spousal support, if any, and end date		
Dispute process before court		
My lawyer's name and phone		

One-Page Timeline

HOW TO USE THIS

List the dates that matter, oldest first: when you married, when each child was born, moves, job changes, when you separated, who moved out, and every filing or hearing. One line each, facts only. Bring it to your first consult. It saves your lawyer 20 minutes of questions.

Date	What happened	Proof (if any)